

UNISON London Ambulance Branch



TOGETHER AT ALL TIMES

April 2020

UNISON is the biggest union for ambulance workers with over 20,000 members across the country.

The London Ambulance Branch is the biggest and fastest growing union with over 4000 members.



Despite what the Health Secretary says, the most precious resource is not PPE - it's *you!*

UNISON advice remains the same:

-  Risk assess every job
-  If you feel there's an infection risk, consider upgrading your PPE
-  Wear a long sleeve apron/tyvek suit and an FFP3 mask
-  Escalate any concerns to your reps
-  Use covid19@lasunison.com to log unresolved issues
-  Stay safe

PPE update



The LAS guidance on this issue has fluctuated considerably throughout the pandemic.

Negotiations to resolve this have been led by UNISON.

Here's what has happened so far and what we advise...

- Public Health England have made changes in the level of PPE their guidance says is safe.
- Management tell us the changes are as a result of PHE research undertaken in their laboratory since the virus emerged in the UK.
- This research apparently concluded that the virus is transmitted by large fluid droplets primarily from respiratory origin.
- Hence, the earlier precautions of full PPE (FFP3 mask, eye protection, double gloves and tyvek suit) have now been deemed over-precautious.
- They now say possible or confirmed Covid-19 jobs only require FFP2 or surgical mask, disposable apron, double gloves and eye protection.
- They still suggest full PPE for any aerosol generating procedure (AGP).
- LAS UNISON are still trying to obtain clear evidence to reference this change.
- In the meantime we advise our members to **adhere to this guidance as a minimum**
- It is our union who have successfully argued for the LAS to step outside of PHE guidelines in allowing our members to adopt what we consider to be this minimum safe level *at all times*.
- Our Branch will continue to monitor supply levels of PPE.
- We advise all members to highlight any deficiencies as a matter of urgency.

PPE update



Mask "D" is here

Even prior to the global pandemic we find ourselves in, UNISON was asking questions and applying pressure regarding personal issue FFP3 masks.

We drew the service's attention to the problem of the existing personal-issue mask filters expiring in November 2018.

Now we have "Mask D" - personal-issue once more and prioritised for staff who have failed the fit-testing for current FFP3 models in circulation.



Ultra-low breathing resistance with improved inhalation/exhalation rates

Optimised field of view, peripheral vision and high quality eye protection

5-point adjustable head harness for widest range of sizing.

Impact and scratch resistant, flame-retardant polycarbonate visor,

Easy to maintain, with all parts of the respirator fully replaceable and available as spare parts

Filter efficiency 99.99% at 0.3 micron

A message from Branch Secretary Eddie Brand

Dear Members,

I hope you and your families are keeping well.

At the time that this newsletter is being finished and printed we are still in discussions with LAS Management regarding payments towards NQPs and our NETS members, due to their role being changed quite considerably. We are hopeful that this will be resolved very soon.

Please stay safe, Eddie Brand, LAS UNISON Branch Secretary

EOC News



Our UNISON staff side representatives in EOC and IUC have, as usual, been working hard to support our members and address the concerns raised by them.



In the past few months UNISON has achieved the following for its members.

- * Installation of adjustable desks in both EOCs.
- * Disabled access at HQ is in the final stages and waiting for approval.
- * Disabled access at Bow is in progress. Internal doors have been made automatic.
- * Installation of dividers between call-handling positions have been agreed for EOCs and IUC to promote social distancing.
- * Agreement has been secured to extend mess room facilities to the first and second floor at Bow in view of social distancing.
- * Air-conditioning work at Bow is in final stages of completion.
- * Decluttering of Bow is also in progress.
- * UNISON continues to offer guidance for staff working over the April - March 2020 Ramadan via our Equality & Inclusion Officer, based at HQ.



For all and any concerns, Covid-related or otherwise, please contact your local reps. We are here for you now, as always - **your friend at work.**

Looking after each other



...at work

Ten minutes briefing time at the start of your shift. This was part of the assurances given to UNISON that management support would improve as a result of station consolidation.

Remember your welfare. The LAS Stress Management Policy makes it clear that staff can be made unavailable *following a traumatic incident which overwhelms the normal coping mechanism*. Staff and managers are advised that returning to station or work base is often particularly valuable and a chance to 'decompress'.

Get those freebies! BP are offering free hot drinks to staff at selected sites, Costa are giving away free canned coffee drinks at their hospital-based outlets, Just Eat, Uber Eats, WHSmith and many others are offering discounts so keep checking online and in store.

Free taxis from and to work are available from Addison Lee. Sign up at www.addisonlee.com/nhs-sign-up/

...and elsewhere



LAS UNISON are sponsoring the Wellbeing Hub by donating £10,000 towards hampers for staff who are unwell and self-isolating. Contact Nicola Bullen with your name address and mobile number to receive an isolation pack. Over 500 have already been given out to staff.

Employee Assistance Programme for colleagues requiring support and financial advice on **0800 882 4102** or via www.pamgroup.co.uk (Login: londonamb Password: LAS1)

LINC Support is available as always from trained colleagues via local management or **0207 922 7539**

White Ribbon UK is a charity whose aim is to end male violence against women. They have produced a Corona Crisis Survival Kit for men. It can be downloaded from whiteribbon.org.uk UNISON are proud to support this campaign.

Looking after each other



NHS Mental Health Hotline to get advice from thousands of specially trained volunteers during this global health crisis. Phone **0300 131 7000** or text **FRONTLINE** to **85258**

There For You is the name of UNISON's welfare service, providing confidential support for members with personal problems at home. For more information contact us on **020 7121 5620** or email **thereforyou@unison.co.uk**

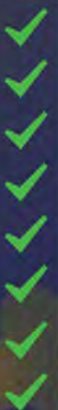


Emergency Accommodation is available for those staff who are having isolation issues or live with vulnerable relatives via **covid19accommodation@londonambulance.nhs.uk**

UNISON Rewards offers members discounted goods and services plus cashback from various partnered companies via the smartphone and iPad app.

NHS priority shopping at the following retailers:

- Aldi - Priority entrance and checkout every day, 30 minutes pre-shop on Sunday
- Asda - NHS priority at larger stores Mon, Wed, Fri 8am - 9am
- Co-op - Skip queues, get 10% discount and priority for 1st hour of trade every day
- Iceland - NHS only during the final hour of trade every day
- M&S - NHS only for first hour of trade every Tuesday and Friday
- Morrisons - NHS hour 7am - 8am Mon to Sat (access via staff entrance) +10% discount
- Sainsbury's - Reserved for NHS 7.30a. - 8am Mon to Sat
- Waitrose - Priority entrance and checkout, some essential stock reserved for NHS



EMTs - don't forget to check your April payslip for the Band 5 uplift!

For all and any concerns, Covid-related or otherwise, please contact your local reps. We are here for you now, as always - **your friend at work.**



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£1.30
A MONTH



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We use this to contact you about trade union activities and services

This information helps us find the best UNISON branch to support and represent your needs

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Employer's name
Your job title or occupation
Workplace name and address
Postcode

³ What you will pay each month

Please tick the appropriate box for your earnings before deductions

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£0,000 – £2,000	£1.30	☐	£17,001 – £20,000	£11.50 ☐
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Instruction to deduct the subscription from my salary

By signing the below I wish to join UNISON and authorise deduction of subscriptions from my pay by my employer

Signature	Date
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Join the biggest Ambulance branch in the country

Every member, wherever they work, receives our full range of member benefits and services which include:

- Advice, support and help when you need it at work
- A helpline that is open until midnight
- Legal help for you at work and your family at home
- Financial assistance and debt advice in times of need
- Compensation for accidents and injuries at work.



This information helps us to see if you were previously a member This information tells us whether you wish to contribute an additional 5% toward UNISON's campaign fund. This voluntary contribution will be taken annually in October as a single deduction by Direct Debit. Further information is available at www.unison.org.uk/changes This information is standard direct debit mandate information Please go to unison.org.uk/privacy-policy to see how we will protect and use your personal information We are legally required to keep your information up to date. You can amend your details via My UNISON at www.unison.org.uk/my-unison	☐ Email ☐ Text ☐ Phone By ticking these boxes, you are giving your consent for UNISON to contact you by these means about how we campaign on your behalf. National insurance number Date of birth 4 Campaign fund contribution UNISON stands up for its members and speaks out publicly on the issues that affect them. To continue this work we ask for a voluntary 5% campaign contribution by Direct Debit when you join. Please tick your preference below: ☐ Campaign Fund The campaign fund promotes better public services, enables the union to talk with politicians of any party about the work our members do and supports the union's equalities work. ☐ UNISON Labour Link Labour Link campaigns for UNISON policy on the NHS, your employment rights and for quality public services within the Labour Party locally and in Parliament. ☐ No thank you I do not wish to contribute to campaigning at the moment. Those who choose not to opt in will not be disadvantaged in any way as compared with members who do opt in. ☐ If you selected 'No thank you' – by ticking this box you are giving consent for UNISON to contact you in future about our campaign funds. We will do this using the contact details you provided on this form. Instruction to your bank or building society to pay by Direct Debit ☒ Please complete the form and send to: UNISON, 130 Euston Road, London NW1 2AY Name and full postal address of your bank or building society To the manager bank / building society Address Postcode Name(s) of account holder(s) Account number Branch sort code Service user no. Reference number 970050 Please pay UNISON Direct Debits from the account detailed in this Instruction subject to the safeguards assured by the Direct Debit Guarantee. I understand that this Instruction may remain with UNISON and, if so, details will be passed electronically to my bank/building society. Signature Date Banks and building societies may not accept Direct Debit instructions for some types of account
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Once completed, please give to your local UNISON Rep or send direct to Eddie Brand UNISON Office, HQ, Waterloo. You can also join online at lasunison.com or call free on 0800 171 2193